


FREE PROMPT PACK

# The Story Behind *the Object*: the prompts

Every prompt I used to make a World War II film starring my brother, an antique dealer, and the real 1940 banknote he sells. Turn any product into a story people stop scrolling for. Copy, paste, swap in your own details.

BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

BEFORE YOU START

# Put someone else *in the story*

In London and Paris I put myself into history. After those videos, so many of you asked how to do it with someone else that I made this one with my brother. He's an antique dealer, and every object he sells has a story that a product photo can't tell. A short film can.

The video has 7 shots and runs 32 seconds: the banknote is printed in 1940, used, smuggled by a paratrooper, stamped as a fake, and one survives in his office today, where he speaks the last line in his own voice.

## WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account.** Images cost 2.75 credits each at high quality. Video costs 7 credits a second at 720p or 16 at 1080p. My whole video came to 826 credits, about $50.
- **Claude with the Higgsfield connector** (Settings, Connectors, Discover, then search Higgsfield). It uploads the photos once, writes the long prompts, checks every result and does the editing.
- **5 to 10 photos of the person.** Front and side angles, natural light, nobody else in them.
- **A clear photo of the real product**, and a photo of the real shop or office if it appears.
- **Optional:** a short voice note from them, and ElevenLabs for custom music.

## THE FIVE STEPS

1. **Build the character:** one character sheet, at high quality.
2. **Set every scene:** one still per shot, approved before any video.
3. **Bring it to life:** animate each still with sound effects only.
4. **Their real voice:** lip-sync the last shot to their own recording.
5. **Finish:** captions, music and the final cut.

Go to Higgsfield here: higgsfield.ai

Before step 1

# Give the object *a life story*

Don't film a product. Film its journey: where it was made, who used it, what nearly destroyed it, and how it ended up in your hands today. The last shot is always the real object with the real person.



Made



Carried




Nearly lost




Survives today

## MY 7 SHOTS

| SHOT | WHAT HAPPENS | LENGTH |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | A printer lifts a fresh sheet of the new notes off the press, Kraków 1940 | 5 s |
| 2 | An old woman pays for bread with the note while a patrol passes the window | 5 s |
| 3 | At a night airfield, he's handed a money belt and buckles it on | 3 s |
| 4 | Green light, and he drops through the hatch of the bomber | 4 s |
| 5 | He lands in a forest and cuts his parachute lines | 3 s |
| 6 | A stamp slams down on a forged note: FALSCH | 4 s |
| 7 | Today: he holds the real note in his office and speaks | 7 s |

**Cut it short.** My first plan had 12 shots and 56 seconds. Seven shots and 32 seconds plays much better as a reel, and costs half as much.

Step 1

# Build the *character*

In Higgsfield go to Images, pick **GPT Image 2.5**, aspect ratio 16:9, and change two settings first: **quality high, resolution 2K.** The default is low quality at 1K, and the faces in the full-body views come out wrong. References: a picture of the real outfit first, then tight face crops of the person.

TEMPLATE

```
Photorealistic historical costume character
reference sheet. The first reference image shows
ONLY the outfit to recreate in real life; the other
reference photos show the man, whose face must be an
exact match in EVERY panel: [FACE SHAPE], [EYES],
[NOSE], [LIPS], [EARS], [HAIR COLOUR AND STYLE],
[HAIRLINE]. He is [HEIGHT, e.g. about 190 cm, slim,
8 heads tall].
Four panels side by side on a plain light grey
seamless studio background: far left a tight chest-
up face close-up looking at camera; then a full-body
front view; then a full-body three-quarter view
turned to the right with his face clearly visible;
then a full-body back view. Frame the full-body
panels tightly, head to boots, faces large and
sharp.
Outfit identical in every panel: [EVERY ITEM, TOP TO
BOTTOM, WITH COLOUR AND MATERIAL]. [ANY HAT OR
HELMET] held in his hand, so his hair always shows.
Calm, friendly expression, natural skin texture, no
retouching, soft even studio light, cinematic
realism. Single subject only, no text, no watermark.
```

MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Photorealistic historical costume character
reference sheet. The first reference image is an
illustration that shows ONLY the outfit to recreate
in real life; the other reference photos show the
man, whose face must be an exact match in EVERY
panel: slightly long oval face with defined jaw and
gently rounded chin, blue-grey eyes, straight nose,
thin lips with a faint closed-mouth smile, ears that
sit slightly out, short dark brown hair with a side
parting swept back and up at the front, shorter on
the sides, slightly receding temples. Four panels
side by side on a plain light grey seamless studio
background: far left a tight chest-up face close-up
looking at camera; then a full-body front view; then
a full-body three-quarter view turned to the right
with his face clearly visible; then a full-body back
view. Frame the full-body panels tightly, head to
boots, faces large and sharp. Standing upright, arms
relaxed. Outfit identical in every panel, recreating
the illustration as real 1943 Polish Cichociemny
paratrooper kit: a loose plain light khaki-brown
cotton drill one-piece parachute jump overall with a
collar, buttoned front and long sleeves, no
camouflage; a curved red shoulder title with white
letters POLAND on the upper left sleeve; a beige
canvas parachute harness with wide webbing straps
over both shoulders, crossing the chest and looping
around both thighs, fastened at a round metal quick-
release box in the centre of the chest; a beige
canvas parachute pack on his back; a plain wide
beige canvas waist belt with one small closed canvas
pouch on his right hip; a closed brown leather tool
sheath strapped to his right thigh holding a
parachutist's rigging line cutter, only its dark
handle visible; khaki trousers tucked into short
olive puttees and brown leather ankle boots. In the
full-body panels he holds a padded tan leather
paratrooper jump helmet with chin strap in his right
hand at his side, so his hair always shows. Calm,
serious expression, clean shaven, mid thirties.
Natural skin texture with visible pores, no
retouching, soft even diffused studio lighting,
cinematic realism, sharp focus on every face. Single
subject only, no other people, no text other than
POLAND on the shoulder title, no watermark, no frame
borders, not an illustration.
```



Default settings: low quality, 1K, helmet on



High quality, 2K, face crops, helmet in hand

Step 1

# Edit, *don't regenerate*

Once a sheet is nearly right, never start again from scratch, because everything else changes too. Use the sheet as the first reference and change one thing.

## FACE ONLY

### TEMPLATE

```
Edit the first reference image (the four-panel
character sheet). Keep everything identical: body,
pose, outfit, background, lighting, layout and
framing. The only change: make his face and head in
every panel an exact match for the real man in the
other reference photos, which show him from the
front, three-quarter and profile angles. [HIS KEY
FEATURES]. Calm, friendly expression, no frown.
Photorealistic, matching the existing image exactly.
```

### MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Edit the first reference image (the four-panel
character sheet). Keep everything identical: body
height and proportions, pose, outfit, harness,
POLAND title, belt pouch, sheath, helmet in hand,
parachute pack, plain chest with no badges,
background, lighting, layout and framing. The only
change: make his face and head in every panel an
exact match for the real man in the other seven
reference photos, which show him from the front,
three-quarter and profile angles. Use the front
photos for the close-up and the front view, and the
three-quarter and profile photos for the three-
quarter view and the back of his head. Match his
real features closely: long oval face, slightly
fuller cheeks, defined jaw and chin, straight nose
with a slightly rounded tip seen in profile, blue-
grey eyes, straight brows, thin lips with a gentle
closed-mouth smile, ears that stick out slightly,
receding temples, short dark brown hair with a side
parting combed up and back at the front, short faded
sides and back. Calm, friendly expression, early to
mid thirties, no frown. Photorealistic, natural skin
texture, no beauty filter, matching the existing
image exactly. No text except POLAND, no watermark.
```

## ONE DETAIL

### TEMPLATE

```
Edit the first reference image. Keep everything
identical. The only change is in the [WHICH PANEL]:
remove [THE DETAIL], so it looks exactly like it
does in the other views.
```

### MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Edit the first reference image (the four-panel
character sheet). Keep everything identical: same
man, same face in every panel, same pose, same
outfit, same harness, same helmet in hand, same
background, lighting, layout and framing. The only
change is in the far right back-view panel: remove
the beige strap that wraps around his right thigh
above the knee, so there is NO strap around the
thigh or knee in any panel. In the back view, the
brown leather tool sheath must look exactly like it
does in the front and three-quarter views: hanging
straight down from the waist belt on his right hip,
its top at belt level and its bottom ending mid-
thigh, attached only at the belt.
```

| PROBLEM | FIX |
|---|---|
| **Doesn't look like them** | Tight face crops as references, plus photos from the side |
| **Looks short** | Give the height in numbers: "about 190 cm, 8 heads tall" |
| **Blocked by the filter** | "Rigging line cutter in a leather tool sheath" worked, "fighting knife" didn't |

Step 2

# Set every *scene*

Make one still per shot with GPT Image 2.5 at 9:16, high quality, 2K. References: the character sheet first, then face crops. The video is made from this still, so fix everything here, where it costs 2.75 credits instead of over 100.

### TEMPLATE

```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic. The
man is the exact man from the character sheet (first
reference) and the face photos: same face, same
hair, same height and build, wearing exactly the
same kit as the sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE].
Scene: [PLACE, DATE, TIME OF DAY]. [WHAT HE IS
DOING, IN ONE OR TWO SENTENCES]. [WHO ELSE IS
THERE].
[SHOT SIZE], his face clearly lit and sharp.
Lighting: [LIGHT, WEATHER, COLOURS], 35mm film look,
shallow depth of field, natural skin texture. No
visible [ANYTHING THAT SHOULD STAY HIDDEN], no text,
no watermark.
```

### MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic. The
man is the exact man from the character sheet (first
reference) and the face photos: same face, same
hair, same height and build, wearing exactly the
same kit as the sheet: plain khaki-brown one-piece
jump overall, red POLAND shoulder title, beige
parachute harness with round metal quick-release box
on the chest, parachute pack on his back, beige belt
with small pouch, brown leather sheath at his right
hip, olive puttees, brown boots, padded tan jump
helmet clipped to his harness. No badges on his
chest. Scene: RAF Tempsford airfield at night, 1943.
He stands on the wet tarmac beside the dark fuselage
of a Handley Page Halifax bomber with its side hatch
open and a dim warm glow inside, propellers and
engine nacelles above, a short metal ladder up to
the hatch. A British RAF officer in a blue-grey
greatcoat and peaked cap, seen from behind and
slightly out of focus, hands him a plain closed
khaki canvas money belt with buttoned pouches;
nothing is visible inside it. He takes it with both
hands and looks down at it, calm, serious and
focused. Medium shot from waist up to just above his
head, his face clearly lit and sharp, the open
bomber hatch behind him. Lighting: night, low
moonlight, a hooded torch and the warm glow from the
hatch on his face, light drizzle, faint mist,
blackout conditions, deep blues and warm amber, 35mm
film look, shallow depth of field, natural skin
texture. No visible money, no text other than
POLAND, no watermark.
```



**Get approval on stills.** I put every frame on one page with the clip length and a line on what the camera does, translated it to Polish and sent it to my brother on WhatsApp before spending anything on video.

**Check the facts.** I asked for a side door on the plane. Those bombers really dropped people through a hole in the floor, so my "fix" was the mistake.

Step 2

# Use the *real product*

AI can't copy a real object exactly, and that's the one detail your customers will look at. Give it the real size ("about 16 cm by 8 cm, roughly the length of his hand"), and for the hero shot put the real photo of the object into the frame. Claude did that for my final shot, warped to his hands, with his thumbs kept in front.

## SWAP IN THE REAL ROOM

### TEMPLATE

```
Edit the first reference image. Keep the man exactly as he is: same face, hair, clothes, pose and the object in his hands. Replace the background entirely with the real room from the second reference image: [DESCRIBE THE ROOM]. He stands in front of [THE BEST PART OF THE ROOM]. Shallow depth of field, his face and the object sharp. Photorealistic.
```

### MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Edit the first reference image. Keep the man exactly as he is: same face (matching the real man in the third and fourth photos), same hair, white open-collar shirt with rolled sleeves, dark trousers, same pose holding the banknote in both hands at chest height and looking down at it with a quiet proud half smile, and the same banknote (exactly like the fifth reference: 1940 Polish 500 zloty note, highlander portrait, red serial A 1320185). Replace the old-fashioned wooden shop entirely with his real modern office from the second reference image: bright white walls, built-in white display cabinets with glass doors and bright LED shelf lighting full of coins in blue presentation cases, medals, graded coin slabs, banknotes in sleeves and small collectables, a tall white glass-door cabinet with antiques at the back, light grey stone floor tiles, a round black-rimmed ceiling light. He stands in front of the illuminated cabinets. Clean, modern, bright, neutral daylight with a soft glow from the cabinets, shallow depth of field so the cabinets blur slightly behind him, his face and the note sharp. Photorealistic, natural skin texture. No other people, no stamps on the note, no other text, no watermark.
```

## PRODUCT MACRO

### TEMPLATE

```
Photorealistic macro product shot, vertical. The exact [OBJECT] from the first reference image, reproduced faithfully: [EVERY VISIBLE DETAIL]. It lies flat on rich black velvet. Extreme close macro, shallow depth of field, soft warm raking side light, deep black background, museum feel. No hands, no text, no watermark.
```

### MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Photorealistic macro product shot, vertical. The exact banknote from the first reference image, reproduced faithfully: the 1940 Polish 500 zloty note of the Bank Emisyjny w Polsce, highlander portrait in an oval guilloche frame, 'PIECSET ZLOTYCH BANK EMISYJNY W POLSCE, KRAKOW 1. MARCA 1940 R.', grey-green and cream paper, red serial number A 1320185 printed twice, slight age toning, soft creases and a gentle fold. It lies flat on rich black velvet. Extreme close macro, shallow depth of field, focus falling across the highlander portrait and the red serial number A 1320185, the rest softly blurred, visible paper fibres and fine engraved lines. Soft warm raking side light from the left, deep black background, elegant museum feel, subtle dust motes. No stamps on the note, no other text, no watermark, no hands.
```

Step 3

# Bring it *to life*

Go to Videos and pick **Seedance 2.5**. Settings: 9:16, audio on, 4 to 7 seconds. Add the still as the **start frame**, then two face crops as references. 720p costs 7 credits a second and looks fine on a phone; 1080p costs 16.

TEMPLATE

```
Continue exactly from the start image, [PLACE AND
YEAR]. [THE PERSON] (keep his face exactly as in the
start image and the face reference photos) [ACTION
1], then [ACTION 2], then [HOW THE SHOT ENDS].
[CAMERA MOVE]. [WHAT MUST STAY THE SAME].
Sound: [3 TO 5 SOUNDS FROM THE SCENE]. No music, no
speech, no text, no subtitles.
```

MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Continue exactly from the start image, forest
clearing in occupied Poland at night, 1943. The
paratrooper (keep his face exactly as in the start
image and the face reference photos) kneels in the
wet grass and saws through the last parachute cords
with the cutter in quick strokes, the white silk
canopy settling behind him, then glances over his
shoulder as the Home Army partisans with red and
white armbands run out of the misty trees towards
him, one flashing his torch. He rises to a crouch
and raises a hand to them. Gentle handheld camera,
moonlight and torch beams in the mist. Sound: night
forest, rustling silk, cords snapping, running
footsteps on twigs, hushed breathing, an owl in the
distance. No music, no speech, no text, no
subtitles.
```

## THE LIP-SYNC SHOT

Same settings, plus his voice note uploaded as an audio reference.

TEMPLATE

```
Continue exactly from the start image, [PLACE],
present day. The man (keep his face exactly as in
the start image and the face reference photos) holds
[THE OBJECT] steady, glances down at it, then lifts
his eyes to the camera and speaks the line from the
audio reference in [LANGUAGE], his lips precisely in
sync with the reference voice: "[THE LINE]".
[DELIVERY]. Very slow camera push-in. [THE OBJECT]
stays exactly as in the start image. Use the
reference voice for his speech; no other voices, no
music, no text, no subtitles.
```

MY PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Continue exactly from the start image, his modern
bright office with illuminated white display
cabinets, present day. The man (keep his face
exactly as in the start image and the face reference
photos) holds the banknote steady in both hands at
chest height, glances down at it, then lifts his
eyes to the camera and speaks the line from the
audio reference in Polish, his lips precisely in
sync with the reference voice: "Pięćset złotych.
Zwykły banknot? Nic bardziej mylnego." Calm, warm,
slightly proud delivery with a small knowing smile
at the end. Very slow, smooth camera push-in. The
banknote stays exactly as in the start image, steady
and unchanged. Use the reference voice for his
speech; no other voices, no music, no text, no
subtitles.
```

**Sound effects only.** Leave music out of the clips. You'll add one track over the whole video at the end.

Steps 4 and 5

# Their voice, *then the finish*

## LIP-SYNC TO THEIR REAL VOICE

1. Ask them for a voice note of the final line, under 7 seconds.
2. Upload it to Seedance as an **audio reference** with the last still as the start frame, so the lips move to their real words.
3. Replace the video's soundtrack with the original recording, and line up where each sentence starts. Mine landed within five hundredths of a second.

## CAPTIONS




A date and place in a typewriter font, a thin red line, and one short sentence on what's happening. Make them in your editor or with Claude, not with the image model, because AI garbles text. Make an English version with subtitles if the voice isn't in English.

## MY ELEVENLABS MUSIC PROMPT, WORD FOR WORD

```
Instrumental cinematic score for a 30 second World War II documentary reel, no vocals, D minor, about 60 BPM. 0:00 to 0:10: low sustained cello drone, sparse cold piano notes, dark, heavy and very quiet. 0:10 to 0:17: a low ticking pulse and soft timpani heartbeat enter, tremolo strings, steadily rising tension. 0:17 to 0:24: full tension peak, driving low string ostinato and deep brass swells, ending on one hard orchestral hit at 0:24. 0:24 to 0:30: sudden calm, a warm gentle solo folk fiddle melody over soft piano chords, ending softly on a resolved chord.
```

**Line up the hit.** Find the big hit in the track and slide the music so it lands on your key moment. Mine lands on the FALSCH stamp. Then turn the music down under the voice.

LEARN FROM MY REDOS

# Five fixes that *saved credits*

1. **Fix in the edit before you re-render.** Two of my clips had one bad second in the middle. I cut it out with a short dissolve instead of paying for a new clip.
2. **Decline the preset.** Higgsfield kept swapping my prompt for a suggested preset. Say no, or you won't get what you asked for.
3. **Wait for slow renders.** One clip took almost an hour. Don't pay to render it twice.
4. **Check prices before you start.** At 720p the videos would have cost about $15 instead of $40.
5. **Hide what looks fake.** Money spilling out of the belt looked silly. Closed pouches looked real.


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